

# Thursday, 3 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

|                               |                                   |                                     |                            |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| LONDON<br>Overcast<br>26° 19° | BIRMINGHAM<br>Overcast<br>23° 17° | MANCHESTER<br>Light rain<br>21° 16° | GLASGOW<br>Rain<br>18° 14° |
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01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 1

**The King and French President Emmanuel Macron have been viewing the historic Bayeux Tapestry at a special exhibition in London.**

The British Museum is hosting the famous 11th-century tapestry, which depicts the Norman Conquest of England. It's a rare chance to see the iconic artwork outside of France.

HISTORY · UK
- 2

**Reform UK leader Nigel Farage has hit back at questions over his party's funding, telling the BBC we live in a 'complainants' society'.**

He suggested a 'whole ecosystem' was against new political movements succeeding. The comments came after scrutiny regarding Reform UK's financial backing.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

**Four people have been arrested in connection with the murder of a woman 32 years ago, thanks to advances in forensic science.**

Police say a review of evidence in the cold case led to the breakthrough. It's a testament to how new technology can help solve historical crimes.

CRIME · UK
- 4

**An inquest has opened into the tragic deaths of a family who got into difficulty in the sea at Shoreham.**

Hussam El-Khawas, Zeina Alayan, and their two young daughters died in the incident. The inquest will aim to establish the full circumstances.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 5

**NHS emergency departments are seeing children as young as six arriving in mental health crisis, including cases of self-harm and eating disorders.**

It highlights a growing concern about the mental well-being of young people in the UK. Doctors are seeing more instances of emotional distress in primary school-aged children.

HEALTH · UK

## What's coming up

- 1 British rock band Kasabian have opened up about their unexpected 'third act' in music, admitting they never thought they'd see success again.**

The band invited the BBC into their studio to talk about their career resurgence. It's a candid look at their journey and renewed popularity.

**ON AIR** – It's great when a band gets a second wind! Which artists have you seen make a brilliant comeback?

MUSIC · NOW
- 2 A long-serving star of the medical drama Casualty is set to lead the show's 40th-anniversary special, calling it 'a real privilege'.**

The BBC medical drama will celebrate the milestone in September with a special two-part story. Fans are eagerly anticipating the landmark episodes.

**ON AIR** – Forty years is incredible! What's your favourite long-running TV show that's still going strong?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 Star Trek fans are aiming to break the record for the largest Vulcan salute at the Science Museum on Star Trek Day.**

The iconic hand gesture is a hallmark of the sci-fi franchise. It's a fun way for fans to celebrate their beloved universe.

**ON AIR** – Are you a Star Trek fan, or do you prefer Star Wars? Which sci-fi universe reigns supreme?

EVENT · SOON
- 4 The Christmas special for the TV series 'The Other Bennet Sister' has wrapped filming, with producers sharing the news online.**

Fans of the period drama can look forward to three special festive episodes. It promises to be a treat for viewers over the holidays.

**ON AIR** – Christmas specials are a tradition! Which TV show's festive episodes do you look forward to the most?

TV · CHRISTMAS
- 5 Victoria Beckham's fashion and beauty business has made its first profit in 18 years, reporting a £7.3 million operating profit.**

After years of losses, it's a significant turnaround for the brand. It shows her dedication to the business is paying off.

**ON AIR** – Eighteen years to turn a profit is a long game! What's the longest you've ever stuck with something to see it succeed?

FASHION · NOW

## On the schedule

### 1 **Manchester City have signed winger Iliman Ndiaye from Everton in a deal worth up to £65 million, completing his journey from non-league football.**

It's a huge move for the player, showcasing an incredible rise through the ranks. Ndiaye's talent has clearly caught the eye of the Premier League champions.

**ON AIR** – What an incredible rags-to-riches story! Which sports star's journey from humble beginnings to the top truly inspires you?

FOOTBALL · UK

### 2 **Maia Bouchier hit a magnificent 104 runs off 95 balls to guide England to a record-breaking victory against Ireland in their One Day International.**

Her superb innings included 11 boundaries, helping England secure a dominant win. It was a fantastic display of form in the first of three ODIs.

**ON AIR** – A century is always special! What's the most memorable individual performance you've seen in any sport?

CRICKET · UK

### 3 **Formula 1 world champion Lando Norris is setting up his own junior team to support young drivers on their path to the top.**

The initiative aims to help aspiring racers navigate the challenging route to F1. It's a great way for Norris to give back to the sport.

**ON AIR** – It's brilliant to see champions supporting the next generation! Which sporting legend would you love to see mentor young talent?

F1 · UK

### 4 **Everton's transfer deadline day debacle over Folarin Balogun has left owners The Friedkin Group facing a fan mutiny.**

The failed move for Balogun has caused significant anger among supporters. It highlights the frustrations when big transfer targets don't materialise.

**ON AIR** – Transfer deadline day can be so dramatic! What's the most frustrating transfer saga your team has ever been involved in?

FOOTBALL · UK

### 5 **Fabio Wardley says there are 'zero excuses' as he prepares for his highly anticipated rematch with WBO heavyweight champion Daniel Dubois.**

The fight is set for October 17th, with Wardley looking to avenge his previous loss. It promises to be a thrilling encounter in the boxing world.

**ON AIR** – Rematches can be even more exciting than the original! Which sporting rematch are you most looking forward to, or would love to see?

BOXING · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 The joy of 'upcycling old furniture' is sweeping the nation as a creative and sustainable hobby.**  
Instead of buying new, more people are finding immense satisfaction in transforming pre-loved items into stylish pieces, adding a touch of personality to their homes and helping the planet too.
- 2 A surprising new study suggests that 'spending time near water', whether it's a river or a fountain, can significantly reduce stress.**  
Researchers found that the gentle sounds and visual tranquility of water sources have a calming effect on our minds, promoting a sense of well-being.
- 3 The trend of 'community book swaps' is flourishing, encouraging neighbours to share their favourite reads.**  
Little free libraries and organised swap meets are popping up everywhere, fostering a love of reading and building stronger local connections, one page at a time.
- 4 More Britons are embracing the simple pleasure of 'picnicking outdoors', rain or shine, as a delightful way to enjoy nature.**  
From local parks to scenic viewpoints, people are rediscovering the charm of packing a hamper and enjoying a casual meal al fresco with friends and family.
- 5 The comforting craft of 'knitting and crocheting' is seeing a resurgence among younger generations.**  
It's not just for grannies anymore! Young people are finding mindfulness and creativity in creating everything from cosy scarves to intricate home décor.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'local history tours' is emerging, with many exploring the hidden stories of their own towns.**  
People are becoming armchair historians, delving into the fascinating pasts of their communities, uncovering forgotten tales and local legends.
- 7 The simple act of 'waving to neighbours' is being championed as a way to boost community spirit and well-being.**  
It might seem small, but these friendly gestures can make a big difference, creating a warmer, more connected neighbourhood for everyone.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

**ANSWER:** SMELLING THE WRAPPER VERY INTENTLY.

**Q** Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot piece of toast, especially if it's got a new topping. What is it?

**ANSWER:** WIPING AWAY ANY TINY CRUMBS FROM THE PLATE FIRST.

TALK TOPIC

- We all have that 'one item in our home' that we've had forever, perhaps it was a gift, or something we picked up years ago, and it just holds so many memories.

What's that cherished item in your home that might not be worth much financially, but is absolutely priceless to you because of the stories it could tell?

- You know how sometimes a 'particular smell' can just transport you back to a specific moment or place in your childhood?

What's a scent that instantly takes you back in time, and what memory does it conjure up for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat, particularly brine shrimp and algae rich in carotenoid pigments?

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** It's true that if you put a chameleon on a tartan rug, it would explode from trying to match so many colours at once.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£76 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£76 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is called a 'business'.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The sound of Big Ben's chimes is E major.
- The world's oldest known living tree is over 5,000 years old and is a bristlecone pine.
- Elephants are the only animals that can't jump.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- Penguins are birds, but they cannot fly; their wings are adapted for swimming.

## On this day

Day 246 of the year, 119 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Bartholomew Gutierrez; Christian feast day: Blessed Brigida Morello Zancano; Christian feast day: Mansuetus of Toul; Christian feast day: Marinus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Redfoo, American singer-songwriter, producer, and dancer
- 1964 — Holt McCallany, American actor
- 1969 — John Fugelsang, American comedian, actor, and talk show host
- 1970 — Gareth Southgate, English footballer and manager
- 1944 — Geoff Arnold, English cricketer and coach
- 1981 — Fearne Cotton, English television and radio presenter
- 1956 — Stephen Woolley, English director and producer
- 1933 — Tompall Glaser, American singer-songwriter (died 2013)

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1933 — Yevgeniy Abalakov is the first man to reach the highest point in the Soviet Union, Communism Peak (now called Ismoil Somoni Peak and situated in Tajikistan) (7495 m).
- 1989 — Cubana de Aviación Flight 9046 crashes into a residential area of Havana shortly after takeoff from José Martí International Airport, killing 150.
- 1954 — The People's Liberation Army begins shelling the Republic of China-controlled islands of Quemoy, starting the First Taiwan Strait Crisis.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1943 — World War II: British and Canadian troops land on the Italian mainland. On the same day, Walter Bedell Smith and Giuseppe Castellano sign the Armistice of Cassibile, although it is not announced for another five days.
- 1971 — Qatar becomes an independent state.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1941 — The Holocaust: Karl Fritzsche, deputy camp commandant of the Auschwitz concentration camp, experiments with the use of Zyklon B in the gassing of Soviet POWs.

- 1945 — A three-day celebration begins in China, following the Victory over Japan Day on September 2.
- 1989 — Varig Flight 254 crashes in the Amazon rainforest near São José do Xingu in Brazil, killing 12.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 247 of the year, 118 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Candida the Elder; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine of Racconigi; Christian feast day: Blessed Dina Bélanger; Christian feast day: Hermione of Ephesus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Lucie Silvas, English singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1996 — Jordan Lilley, English rugby league player
- 1960 — Kim Thayil, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1994 — Thomas Minns, English rugby player
- 1993 — Emma Brownlie, Scottish footballer
- 1928 — Dick York, American actor (died 1992)
- 1981 — Beyoncé, American singer-songwriter
- 1978 — Wes Bentley, American actor and producer

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2024 — A 14-year-old gunman kills four people and injures seven in a mass shooting at Apalachee High School near Winder, Georgia.
- 1977 — The Golden Dragon massacre takes place in San Francisco.
- 1972 — The Price Is Right premieres on CBS. It currently is the longest running game show on American television.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1967 — Vietnam War: Operation Swift begins when U.S. Marines engage the North Vietnamese in battle in the Que Son Valley.
- 1964 — Scotland's Forth Road Bridge near Edinburgh officially opens.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

## Coming to cinemas

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### SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

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| FRI 4 | Conjuring: Last Rites |
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| FRI 11 | Resident Evil reboot |
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| FRI 18 | The Black Phone 2 |
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| FRI 25 | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX) |
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### OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

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| FRI 16 | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller |
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| FRI 23 | Frankenstein (del Toro) |
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

## On the sporting calendar